



3. ReplicatorG software

Speaking of open source hardware, what good would it be if it didn't have a solid open source software to back it up? Introducing 'ReplicatorG', the easy-to-use open source 3D printing program which powers many open source 3D printers. Currently in version 0040, the ReplicatorG is cross-platform software that is available for Windows, Linux

and Mac. It's based on Arduino, an open source single-board microcontroller, intended to make the application of interactive objects and/or environments more accessible. For its operations, ReplicatorG uses Gcode, which is a control language for CNC machines.

Using the ReplicatorG is as simple as installing it, connecting the printer, loading the STL files, configuring the print settings and taking the printer for a spin. There are plenty of files on Thingiverse.com to get you started with 3D printing.

4. Tantillus

With 3D printers becoming a rage, more people are open to the idea of on-the-go printing. This presents the problem of portability, with a majority of printers being big and clunky. This problem was solved by the 'Tantillus', a portable open source 3D printer with a compact box-shaped design. The Tantillus can print its entire case, which fairly brings it into the category of self-replicating printers. It's quite compact with dimensions of 240mm x 240mm x 300mm and weight of just 4 kgs (including the power supply). One great feature of the Tantillus 3D printer is that you don't even need to connect it to a computer to take prints as you can print via the LCD screen and SD card on

